L-P-65B
May 18, 1973
SUPERSEDING
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May 27, 1964

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAIL PLASTIC (POLYETHYLENE, PE)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic pails (buckets) for carrying water, paint and other liquids, and dry materials (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The plastic pails shall have the following respective capacities for various size numbers, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - 5 pint
Size 2 - 5 quart
Size 3 - 9 to 10-1/2 quart
Size 4 - 11 to 13-1/2 quart

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids, or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-390 - Plastic, Molding and Extrusion Material, Polyethylene and Copolymers (Low, Medium and High Density).
QQ-W-428 - Wire, Steel, High Carbon, Round, Uncoated for Mechanical Springs. (General Purpose).
QQ-W-461 - Wire, Steel, Carbon, (round, bare, coated).
PPP-B-585 - Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade) and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P St., N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Plastic. The pails shall be manufactured from high density polyethylene or low density polyethylene, at the manufacturer's option, provided they meet the requirements specified herein. The plastic shall be virgin material; however, up to 5% clean unburned plastic material in the form of imperfect parts, sprues, runners or other scrap of the same composition as the virgin material and produced in the molding or finishing operation may be reground and mixed with the material specified. Pails made by rotational molding shall be made from virgin material only.

3.1.1.1 Low density polyethylene. The low density polyethylene used in the pails shall conform to type I class L, grade 1, or 2 of L-P-390.

3.1.1.2 High density polyethylene. The high density polyethylene used in the pails shall conform to type I, class H, grade 1, or 3 of L-P-390.

3.1.2 Steel wire. The bail wire shall conform to one of the steel numbers 1010 through 1020, finish 5, class 1, hard temper of QQ-W-461. The top reinforcing wire shall conform to type II of QQ-W-428.

3.2 Body.

3.2.1 Size 1, 2 and 3 pails. The sides and bottom of the pail shall be an integral unit not less than 0.045 inches thick. The top rim of the pail shall be curled outward and down the side of the pail at least 1/8 inch. The pail shall be tapered so as to meet in a manner that each additional pail of the same size when nested will not add more than 1-1/8 inch in height to the stack. Any difference between the measurements of the bottom diameter and the height of the side of the pail shall not exceed one inch.

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3.2.2 Size 4 pail. Body shall meet the requirements of 3.2.1 except that the side and bottom shall not be less than 0.060 inch thick and the top rim shall curl down the side of the pail at least 1/4 inch.

3.2.3 Graduations. All pails shall be graduated to indicate each pint measure on the size 1 and each quart measurement on the sizes 2, 3 and 4 pails, either inside or outside at the manufacturer's option. The height of the pails shall not be less than 1/4 inch above the top or maximum capacity graduation.

3.3 Bails and reinforcing runs.

3.3.1 Size 1 pail. The pail shall be furnished with or without a bail or reinforcing rim at the manufacturer's option.

3.3.2 Size 2, 3 and 4 pails. The pail shall be furnished with two diametrically opposite integral plastic ears, extending above or below the rim, for attaching the bail. The bail shall be attached to the ears in such a manner as to prevent disassembly when in use. If required to assure compliance with 3.8, a reinforcing steel wire shall be concealed under the curled pail rim and the ends of the wire shall meet, or come within 1/4 inch of meeting, reinforcements shall be in accordance with table I.

TABLE I.

Pail size	Bail inch	Rim reinforcement inch
1	0.121 min.	0.090 min.
3	0.133 min.	0.105 min.
4	0.136 min.	0.105 min.

3.4 Capacities. The capacity in pints or quarts when the pail is filled to the top graduation, shall be not less than that specified for the applicable size number (see 1.2).

3.5 Marking for identification. Each pail shall be marked or labeled with the manufacturers name or trademark.

3.6 Color. The color of the pails shall be at the option of the manufacturer.

3.7 Leakage. The pails shall be watertight and shall show no evidence of leakage when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.

3.8 Maximum allowable diametral deflections. When tested in accordance with 4.4.5, the pail shall not exceed the following maximum allowable diametral deflections:

Size 2, 1-1/2 inches
Size 3, 1-7/8 inches
Size 4, 2 inches

The pails shall not be permanently deformed or broken nor shall the bail or attachments to the body pull out or be deformed.

3.9 Drop test. The pails shall show no cracks or permanent set when tested in accordance with 4.4.6.

3.10 Workmanship. The pails shall be free of fins, sharp edges and defects that may affect their durability or serviceability. The polyethylene shall be free from contamination (dirt and foreign matter).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilitieis or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all pails of the same size, submitted for inspection at the same time.

4.2.2 Visual examination of end item. Examination shall be made of the end item for the defects in table II. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

4.2.3 Sampling for tests. Sapling for tests shall be in accordance with level S-2 in MIL-STD-105. The AQL for tests shall be 6.5 on the basis of percent defective.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 End item. Pails selected in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table II.

TABLE II. Classification of defects, end items

Defects	Major	Minor
Size not as specified.	X	
Fins or sharp edges.	X	
Measurement marking illigible.	X	
Bail does not have clearance or function properly.		X
Damage or defects not affectively function serviceability.		X
Damage or defects affecting function or serviceability.	X	
Top graduation not correct distance from top of pail.		X

4.3.2 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at ramdom just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed in table III shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component mssing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate applications of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate strapling. Distortion of container.
Weight	Weight of container exceeds the specified limitation.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 General. Pails selected in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be tested to verify compliance with specification.

4.4.2 Graduations test. The pail shall be filled to each graduation with measured amounts of water to determine that the graduations are ~~correct~~ (see 3.2.3).

4.4.3 Capacity test. The pail shall be filled to the top graduation with a measured amount of water to determine compliance.

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4.4.4 Leakage. The pail shall be filled to the top graduation with water and allow to stand for not less than one hour. Examination shall then be made to determine compliance with 3.7.

4.4.5 Diametral deflection test. The outside diameter of the pails which extends through the centers of the bail attachment holes of the body shall be measured. The pails shall be filled with water to the brimful capacity. The water temperature shall be 130°F. plus or minus 5°F. The pails shall be emptied after 5 minutes of time has elapsed and refilled as above. After two minutes of time has elapsed, the pails shall be lifted and the shorter deflected outside diametral dimension which extends through the centers of the bail attachment holes of the body shall be measured while the pails are suspended. The pails shall meet the requirements of 3.8.

4.4.6 Drop test. The pail shall be filled to brimful capacity with crushed ice. After 15 minutes of time have elapsed, the pail shall be raised to a height of 3 feet above a concrete floor and a tilted at an angle of approximately 45°. The pails shall be released and allowed to fall freely, with the bottom pail edge striking the concrete. The pails shall meet the requirements of 3.9.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pail shall be packaged method III in accordance with MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level B. Each pail shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The pails shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Pails of like description packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be nested and packed in boxes conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3, PPP-B-591, class II, PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2 PPP-B-636, grade V2s, or PPP-B-640, class 2, style A. Fiberboard meeting the requirements of PPP-F-320 shall be utilized for partitions between the nested pails. The fiberboard boxes shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. Weight of contents of each PPP-B-636 fiberboard container shall not exceed 65 pounds. The gross weight of the PPP-B-636 fiberboard box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Pails of like description packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be nested and packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Fiberboard meeting the requirements of PPP-F-320, shall be utilized for partitions between the nested pails. The box shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix to the box specification. Weight of contents of each PPP-B-636 fiberboard container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Pails, Packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Plastic pails covered by this specification are intended to be used for carrying water, paint, and other liquids or dry materials. They should not be used to carry or store concentrated acids or strong oxidizing agents. They are not intended for carrying or storing potable water.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2).
(c) Size of lot, if different from 4.2.1.
(d) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(e) When weather resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - GL
Air Force - 84

Review interest:

Army - MD

User interest:

Navy - CG

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

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